

In Phase 4 children learn to read and spell words containing adjacent consonants (blends). Many children may be capable of taking this step much earlier, in which case they should not be held back from doing so. No new grapheme - phoneme correspondences are taught in this phase.

Children entering Phase 4 will be able to represent each of the 42 phonemes by a grapheme, and be able to blend phonemes to read CVC words and segment CVC words for spelling. They will have experience in reading simple two-syllable words and captions. They will know letter names and be able to read and spell some tricky words.

The purpose of this phase is to consolidate students knowledge of graphemes in the reading and spelling of words containing adjacent consonants and polysyllabic words. The teaching materials in this phase provide a selection of suitable words containing adjacent consonants. These words are for using in the activities - practising blending for reading and segmenting for spelling.

Adjacent consonants are not taught as units of sound, but rather applied within larger word formations such as CVCC, CCVC and CCCVC words (here, the C stands for consonant and the V for vowel). These words contain adjacent consonants and enable both the revision of previously taught graphemes as well as the expansion of word knowledge and vocabulary. Adjacent consonants are grouped together, based on their principles of beginning blends, final blends and trigraph blends. There are also opportunities for learning words containing blends and long vowels, as well as multi-syllabic words containing adjacent consonants.

Letter Progression

Phase 4 – Blends

CVCC (nd mp nt, nk ft st, lt lk sk)	CCVC (fr br, cr tr, gr dr pr)
CCVC (pl bl gl, sl fl cl, st sp sn, sm sw)	CCVCC (short vowel)
CVCC CCVC CCVCC (long vowel)	CCCVC CVCCC